Self-Hosting & Install Guide

From git clone to first check in ten minutes — Docker or bare PHP.

Exposure-Check-OSINT v1.6.0 · Apache-2.0 · self-hosted · keyless · no AI · github.com/RanaKhan77/Exposure-Check-OSINT

Quick start (Docker, recommended)

```
git clone https://github.com/RanaKhan77/Exposure-Check-OSINT.git
cd Exposure-Check-OSINT
./install.sh # builds + boots one container, generates your password
```

Open http://localhost:8080/login and sign in with the printed password. That is the whole install. Data (history, settings, license) lives in the ec-db and ec-storage Docker volumes and survives upgrades.

Custom port: ./install.sh --port 9090 · Custom password: ./install.sh --password 'your-strong-password'

Daily operations

```
docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml logs -f # follow logs
docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml restart # restart
docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml down # stop (data persists)
docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml pull || \
git pull && docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml up -d --build # upgrade
```

Exposing it remotely (recommended setup)

The container speaks plain HTTP. For anything beyond localhost, put a TLS reverse proxy in front — Caddy makes it one line:

```
exposure.example.com {
reverse_proxy 127.0.0.1:8080
}
```

nginx equivalent:

```
server {
listen 443 ssl http2;
server_name exposure.example.com;
ssl_certificate /etc/letsencrypt/live/exposure.example.com/fullchain.pem;
ssl_certificate_key /etc/letsencrypt/live/exposure.example.com/privkey.pem;
location / {
proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:8080;
proxy_set_header Host $host;
proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Proto https;
proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $proxy_add_x_forwarded_for;
}
}
```

Then set APP_URL=https://exposure.example.com in .env so generated links are correct.

Without Docker (PHP 8.2+ on a VPS)

```
git clone https://github.com/RanaKhan77/Exposure-Check-OSINT.git && cd Exposure-Check-OSINT
composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader
cp .env.example .env
php artisan key:generate
```

```
sed -i "s|^ADMIN_PASSWORD=.*|ADMIN_PASSWORD=$(openssl rand -hex 12)|" .env

touch database/database.sqlite

php artisan migrate --force

php artisan serve --host 127.0.0.1 --port 8080
```

Requires: PHP 8.2+ with pdo_sqlite, sqlite3, curl, mbstring, dom, openssl. For a serious non-Docker deployment use php-fpm + your webserver. If you run php artisan config:cache, remember to re-run it after ANY .env change (cached config stops reading .env — the admin password is read at config load time by design).

Using MySQL instead of SQLite

Set in .env:

```
DB_CONNECTION=mysql

DB_HOST=127.0.0.1

DB_PORT=3306

DB_DATABASE=exposure_check

DB_USERNAME=...

DB_PASSWORD=...
```

Then php artisan migrate --force. SQLite is the default because an own-use personal tool should not need a database server.

Backups

Everything that matters is in two places: storage/app/database.sqlite (or your MySQL) and storage/ (which also holds your .env copy, logs and logo cache). The Docker volumes map to both. sqlite3 storage/app/database.sqlite ".backup backup.db" takes a safe hot copy.

Scheduling (optional, non-Docker)

Since the v2 "no wall" license policy (Oct 2026) there are no scheduled license tasks anymore — the default install makes zero unsolicited network calls. If you run without Docker and later add scheduled features (e.g. you opted into LICENSE_HEARTBEAT=on for the public install map), add one cron entry:

```
* * * * * cd /path/to/Exposure-Check-OSINT && php artisan schedule:run >> /dev/null 2>&1
```